

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONXIndex No.:
Date Purchased:

MANUEL LUGO,

Plaintiff,

-against-

SUMMONS

Plaintiff designates
BRONX County as the
place of trialCITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. GUY GARGANO, UNDER
COVER OFFICER SHIELD C0100 and OFFICER[S]
JOHN AND JAMES DOE, names being fictitious and
meant to designate additional offending officers,
Defendants.The basis of venue is:
CPLR 504 (3)**To the above named Defendants:**

You are hereby summoned to answer the complaint in this action, and
serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to
serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the
service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by
delivery upon you personally within the state, or within 30 days after completion of
service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or
answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the
complaint to be assessed by the Court.

Dated: Bronx, N.Y.

August 20, 2014


By: JONATHAN L. GLEIT, ESQ.
Attorney for Plaintiff888 Grand Concourse
Suite 1-O
Bronx, NY 10451
(718) 742-0200

To:

CITY OF NEW YORK CORPORATION COUNSEL
100 Church Street, 4th Floor, Law Dept.
New York, New York 10007P.O. Guy Gargano Shield No. 014100 and Under Cover Officer Shield No. C0100
NARCBX, 1 Police Plaza, NY NY 10038

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X
MANUEL LUGO,

Plaintiff,

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. GUY GARGANO UNDER
COVER OFFICER SHIELD C0100 and OFFICER[S]
JOHN AND JAMES DOE, names being fictitious and
meant to designate additional offending officers,

Defendants.
-----X

Index No.:

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

Plaintiff, by his attorney, **Jonathan L. Gleit, Esq.**, complaining of the Defendants,

respectfully alleges, upon information and belief, as follows:

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
THE PLAINTIFF MANUEL LUGO

1. At the time of the commencement of this action, plaintiff MANUEL LUGO was

and still is resident of the County of Bronx, City and State of New York.
2. That the causes of action alleged herein arose in the County of Bronx, City and

State of New York.

3. That at all times herein mentioned Defendant CITY OF NEW YORK was, and still is, a Municipal Corporation and body politic, duly formed, organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.

4. That the CITY OF NEW YORK maintains a Police Department.

5. That on and about June 14, 2013, P.O. GUY GARGANO was employed by the CITY OF NEW YORK and THE NEW YORK POLICE DEPARTMENT.

6. That on and about June 14, 2013, at approximately 8:30 P.M., P.O. GUY GARGANO was working and acting within the scope of his employment as a Police Officer, and under the color of law.

7. That on and about June 14, 2013, UNDER COVER OFFICER SHIELD C0100, name presently unknown to plaintiff but known to defendants, was employed by the CITY OF NEW YORK and THE NEW YORK POLICE DEPARTMENT.

8. That on and about June 14, 2013, at approximately 8:30 P.M., UNDER COVER OFFICER SHIELD C0100 was working and acting within the scope of his employment as a Police Officer, and under the color of law.

9. That on and about June 14, 2013, OFFICER[S] JOHN AND/OR JAMES DOE were employed by the CITY OF NEW YORK and THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT.

10. That on and about June 14, 2013 at approximately 8:30 P.M., OFFICER[S] JOHN AND/OR JAMES DOE were working and acting within the scope of their employment as a Police Officer[s], and under the color of law.

11. That on or about June 14, 2013 at approximately 8:30 P.M., at or near the intersection of Marion Avenue and Elsmere Place, Bronx, New York, the plaintiff MANUEL LUGO was improperly arrested, and confined without warrant, privilege, proper authority or justification, having no reason in law or in fact to arrest or confine MANUEL LUGO.

12. That the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees arrested and confined the plaintiff without any basis in law or fact and without reasonable, probable or just cause or justification.

13. That the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees arrested the plaintiff without any basis in law or fact, by making false accusations against him, when they knew, or in the exercise of reasonable care, should have known they were false.

14. That following his aforesaid arrest the plaintiff was strip searched at the 48th Precinct, 450 Cross Bronx Expressway, Bronx, New York, by the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees, without a reasonable, articulable suspicion that he was secreting evidence underneath clothing or within a bodily cavity.

15. That the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees unlawfully arrested, detained, imprisoned and searched the plaintiff and took his property without any basis in law or fact, and plaintiff being aware of his unlawful confinement, thereby causing fright, shock, emotional distress and physical consequences.

16. That the CITY OF NEW YORK allowed, condoned, permitted and caused a policy and procedure of arresting innocent citizens and engaging in a policy and procedure of arresting persons upon pretext and/or the fabrication of evidence, without any probable cause or reasonable basis to do so for nefarious, unlawful reasons such as the fulfillment of arrest quotas and the subjugate minority population without reprimand to the offending officers.

17. That said illegal and unlawful arrests without reasonable or probable cause are a matter of policy and record and openly acknowledged or known by the defendants, yet condoned without any reprimand of the offending officers, referral to the District Attorney or Federal Law Enforcement officials for criminal prosecution, or even bone fide internal investigation to deter actions like those complained of herein.

18. Said policy, practice and procedure of having arrest quotas, euphemistically known as productivity goals, which result in the false arrests of innocent persons is exhibited, for instance, in the November 1, 2011 conviction of New York Police

Department Det. Jason Arbeeny, whereat Justice Gustin Reichbach commented on the evidence presented by several witnesses that officers were expected to make certain arrest goals.

19. Additionally in the case of Floyd, et al. v. City of New York, et al., In the Southern District of New York Case 08 Civ.1034, New York City Police Officer Adhyl Polanco testified in open court and under oath that the NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT routinely arrest primarily minority populations without a legal reason to do so, and are required or expected to do so, to satisfy arrest quotas. Said arrest quotas lead to a practice and procedure of, for instance, arresting persons for conduct that is not criminal.

20. Additionally, Officer Craig Matthews presented evidence in federal court that he was subject to retaliation for reporting said quota system at the 40th Precinct in 2009.

21. Furthermore patterns of wrongful strip searches conducted without a reasonable articulable suspicion that the searched person was secreting evidence within a bodily cavity has occurred to other individuals such as, for instance, ANABAL ROLON and McKINLEY KING, who were strip searched by officers of the 48th Precinct on April 2, 2010; CHARITY GARCIA and TAMARA GARCIA who were strip searched by officers of the 48th Precinct on April 16, 2010 and DAVID ACABEO who was strip searched by

officers of the 48th Precinct on June 16, 2010 and ARAMIS RODRIGUEZ who was strip searched by officers of the 48th Precinct on April 13, 2011 and JONATHAN BAILEY who was strip searched by officers of the 48th Precinct on August 3, 2011 and EDUARDO DEJESUS who was strip searched by officers of the 48th Precinct on February 1, 2012 and May 22, 2012 and is well evidenced by the May 14, 2004 letter by the Civilian Complaint Review Board with attachments to Police Commissioner Raymond Kelly, detailing the NYPD policy of illegal strip searched by their officers, a copy of which is available to the public at <http://www.nyc.gov/html/ccrb/downloads/pdf/stripsearchletter.pdf> and as evidenced by the above and within individuals and countless others demonstrates that said practices continue unabated.

22. That no negligence or actions on the part of the plaintiff contributed to the occurrences alleged herein in any manner whatsoever.

23. The herein above described actions and omissions, engaged in under the color of law by the defendants, including the CITY OF NEW YORK, sued as a person within the meaning of Title 42 U.S.C. 1983, et seq., by policy, procedure and act, deprived the plaintiff of rights secured to him by the Constitution and laws of the United States, including, but not limited to his First Amendment right of freedom of expression, his Fourth Amendment right to be free from unlawful seizures of his person, his Fifth

Amendment rights of due process of law and to equal protection of the laws, including the right to be free from unjustified confinement utilized by the police, his Eighth Amendment right to be free from cruel and unusual punishment, and under Title 42 U.S.C. 1983, et seq.

24. That this cause of action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602.

25. That as a result of the foregoing, the plaintiff MANUEL LUGO was damaged in a sum which exceeds the jurisdiction of all lower Courts.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF

OF THE PLAINTIFF MANUEL LUGO

26. That plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs enumerated 1 through 25 as though more fully set forth herein.

27. That on or about September 9, 2013, and within 90 days after the claim herein sued upon, plaintiff caused a Notice of Claim, sworn to by or on behalf of the claimant, to be presented to the defendant CITY OF NEW YORK, by presenting a copy thereof to the offices of the defendant CITY OF NEW YORK, which said Notice of Claim set forth the name and post office address of the claimant and claimant's attorney, the nature of the claim, the time when, the place where, and the manner in which the claim arose and

items of damage or injuries claimed to have been sustained, so far as then practicable.

At least thirty (30) days have elapsed prior to the commencement of this action since the service of such Notice of Claim as aforesaid and adjustment of payment thereof has been neglected or refused by the defendant, and defendant conducted a General Municipal Law §50h hearing of plaintiff on March 4, 2014, and this action was commenced on the claim within one year and ninety days after the happening of the event upon which the claim is based.

28. That this action is being commenced within one year and ninety days after accrual of this cause of action, or within the time allowed by law.

29. That on or about June 14, 2013 at approximately 8:30 P.M., at or near the intersection of Marion Avenue and Elsmere Place, Bronx, New York, the plaintiff MANUEL LUGO was improperly arrested, and confined without warrant, privilege, proper authority or justification, having no reason in law or in fact to arrest or confine MANUEL LUGO.

30. That at all times herein mentioned, Defendants, their agents, servants and / or employees, deprived the plaintiff of Due Process under Law.

31. That the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees arrested and confined the plaintiff without any basis in law or fact and without reasonable, probable or just cause or justification.

32. That the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees arrested the plaintiff without any basis in law or fact, by making false accusations against him, when they knew, or in the exercise of reasonable care, should have known they were false.

33. That the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees unlawfully arrested, detained, imprisoned and searched the plaintiff and took his property without any basis in law or fact, and plaintiff being aware of his unlawful confinement, thereby causing fright, shock, emotional distress and physical consequences.

34. That no negligence or actions on the part of the plaintiff contributed to the occurrences alleged herein in any manner whatsoever.

35. That this cause of action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602.

36. That as a result of the foregoing, the Plaintiff MANUEL LUGO was damaged in a sum which exceeds the jurisdiction of all lower Courts.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF

OF THE PLAINTIFF MANUEL LUGO

37. That plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs enumerated 1 through 36 as though more fully set forth herein.

38. That following his aforesaid arrest the plaintiff was strip searched at the 48th Precinct, 450 Cross Bronx Expressway, Bronx, New York, by the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees, without a reasonable, articulable suspicion that he was secreting evidence underneath clothing or within a bodily cavity.

39. That as a result of the aforesaid strip search, plaintiff was thereby caused freight, shock, emotional distress and physical consequences.

40. That no negligence or actions on the part of the plaintiff contributed to the occurrences alleged herein in any manner whatsoever.

41. That this cause of action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602.

42. That as a result of the foregoing, the plaintiff MANUEL LUGO was damaged in a sum which exceeds the jurisdiction of all lower Courts.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF

THE PLAINTIFF MANUEL LUGO

43. That Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs enumerated 1 through 42 as though more fully set forth herein.

44. That the defendants carelessly, recklessly and negligently failed to properly interview, hire, select, train, manage, supervise and control its employees, agents, and / or servants and negligently retained its employees, agents, and / or servants.

45. That the defendants carelessly, recklessly and negligently failed to properly interview, hire, select, train, manage, supervise and control its employees, agents, and / or servants and negligently retained its employees, agents, and / or servants in the proper stopping, questioning, searching, detention and arrest of individuals, and in the utilization search procedures without reasonable articulable suspicion of the secreting of evidence.

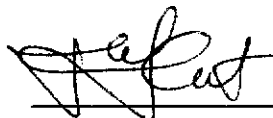
46. That solely by reason of the aforesaid occurrence, and as a direct and proximate result of the defendant's negligence, plaintiff MANUEL LUGO was denied his freedom and rights under the federal and state constitutions and received great and severe injuries with accompanying physical and mental pain and suffering; that the plaintiff was made, still is and will continue to be sick, sore, lame and disabled and sustained other injuries, both internal and external, all of which, upon information and belief, will be permanent; that it was necessary and will be so in the future, to incur medical expenses for the care, treatment and attention of the plaintiff and for the purchase of drugs and medicines, and that plaintiff was and in the future will be prevented from

attending to plaintiff's usual vocation and avocations; all to the plaintiff's damage in a sum which exceeds the jurisdiction of all lower Courts.

47. That this cause of action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiffs demands judgment against the Defendants on the First, Second, Third and Fourth Causes of Action inclusive of punitive damages, and attorneys fees as permitted by statute, all in sums which exceed the jurisdiction of all lower Courts, together with the costs and disbursements of this action.

Dated: Bronx, N.Y.
August 20, 2014


By: **JONATHAN L. GLEIT, ESQ.**
Attorney for Plaintiff
MANUEL LUGO

888 Grand Concourse
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To:

CITY OF NEW YORK
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100 Church Street
4th Floor, Law Dept.
New York, New York 10007

P.O. Guy Gargano Shield No. 014100 and Under Cover Officer Shield No. C0100
NARCBX, 1 Police Plaza, NY NY 10038

PLAINTIFF'S VERIFICATION

MANUEL LUGO affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am Plaintiff in the within action and have read the annexed

Complaint

and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon personal knowledge, facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files.

DATED: BRONX, N.Y.


MANUEL LUGO